PIA2050 Comparative Politics and Societies — Week 4 Summary: A World of "Nation-States"

1. Framing: What Political Development Is About

Keywords: group competition, inter-subjective recognition, nation-state, state-formation, nation-building

- **Recap of Week 3 (Slide 2):** political development is largely about the competition between groups, over:
  - **material resources**;
  - **alternative visions** of how society should be organised/governed;
  - competing claims for **"inter-subjective recognition"** (being acknowledged by others as having legitimate status/identity).
- **This week:** Week 3 covered *how* to study political development; Week 4 asks *what* it is about.
- Key outcome of the past several centuries: the world's transformation into a **world of "nation-states"**, produced by two processes:
  - State-formation (state-making) — Sections 2–5.
  - Nation-building — Sections 6–9.
- One-liner: *the state is the organisation; the nation is the imagined community; the nation-state fuses them.*

2. The Modern State and Sovereignty

Keywords: Weber, monopoly of legitimate force, territory, external vs internal sovereignty, Schmitt, state of exception

2.1 Weber's Definition (Slide 3) (memorise)

Keywords: organisation, monopoly, legitimate physical force, given territory

- "The modern state" is by far the dominant form of political organisation today.
- Weber 1919: "The state is an organization that successfully claims a monopoly on the legitimate use of physical force within a given territory."
- Three key concepts:
  - **(i) Organisation** — formalised administrative, bureaucratic, legal and coercive agencies operating through the continuous, regulated activities of individuals acting as occupants of offices. Officials *occupy* offices; they do not own them.

    - **(ii) Monopoly of legitimate physical force** — excludes **more than one** organisation exercising legitimate force.
    - **(iii) Well-defined territory** — you can **draw a line** showing where a state's sovereignty extends and ends.

- → Each element is a test; feudal Europe failed all three (Section 3.4).

2.2 External vs Internal Sovereignty (Slide 4)

Keywords: independence, self-government, who is sovereign, king, the people

- **External sovereignty** — a country is independent and self-governing; violations are acts that prevent or impede its right to govern itself.
    - *Example:* foreign invasion or imposed rule.
- **Internal sovereignty** — who the sovereign is: where power ultimately resides.
    - Medieval kingdoms: **the king** — understood to own all land and life in the kingdom.
    - Today: most countries claim **"the people"** or **"the nation"** is sovereign.
- → External = sovereignty *between* states; internal = sovereignty *within* a state.

2.3 Schmitt's Test (Slide 4) (memorise)

Keywords: Carl Schmitt, exception, extraordinary measures, real vs claimed sovereign

- Schmitt 1922 (German philosopher, 1888–1985) gives a practical criterion for who *really* is sovereign: "Sovereign is he who decides on the exception."
- State of exception: a severe disturbance requiring the application of extraordinary measures.
- → Whatever the constitution claims, whoever decides when normal rules are suspended holds ultimate power.

3. State-Making I: East Asia, Rome, Feudalism

Keywords: recent innovation, Qin, Confucian bureaucracy, Roman collapse, Dark Ages, feudal anarchy

3.1 Two Key Questions (Slide 5)

Keywords: how states developed, why these states, boundaries

- Modern-state characteristics are, with some exceptions, **fairly recent innovations**.
- **Q1 — How did we end up with modern states?** How did they develop and **prevail over other forms** of political organisation?
- **Q2 — Why the states we have today?** Why did some state-making attempts succeed and many fail? What explains **where boundaries lie**?

- → Q1: war and absolutism (Section 4). Q2: Tilly's conditions plus nation-building (Sections 5–9).

3.2 East Asia: The Earliest Modern States (Slide 6)

Keywords: Qin 221 BCE, merit bureaucracy, exams since 605 CE, Korea, Japan, Vietnam

- Earliest successful modern-state development: **East Asia, especially China**.
- **Qin Dynasty, 221 BCE** — China unified under one empire; hierarchical, **merit-based bureaucracy** with strong **central control over peripheries**, many centuries before the West.
- **Confucian ideas** → bureaucracy based on **merit, not hereditary aristocracy**; selection examinations used (intermittently) **since 605 CE**.
- **By 1400 CE:** China, Korea, Japan and Vietnam had centralised, strong states with hierarchical bureaucracies across much of their territory.
- Caveat: territory was **not precisely demarcated** — not a priority at the time.
- → Strong on Weber's (i) organisation; weak on (iii) defined territory.

3.3 Europe: Rome and Its Collapse (Slides 7, 9)

Keywords: Greece, Rome, 476 CE, fragmentation, Dark Ages, Middle Ages

- European state formation took **many more centuries**; origins in **ancient Greece** and especially **Rome**.
- **By 100 CE** Rome had centralised government and administration; expansion went with **roads and infrastructure**.
- Centuries of decline → break-up in **476 CE** → **political fragmentation**, reinforced by:
    - economic decay; collapse of trade, commerce, productivity;
    - ruin of roads, bridges, aqueducts;
    - falling literacy and life expectancy.
- Dates (memorise): **"Dark Ages" ≈ 500–800 CE** (map, Slide 9); **"Middle Ages" ≈ 500–1500**.

3.4 Feudalism (Slides 10–11)

Keywords: feudal anarchy, fiefs, tribute, protection, serfs, personal ties, overlapping authority

- **How it worked (Slide 10):**
    - Feudalism = weak central governments (feudal anarchy); kings/emperors nominally ruled large territories but controlled little beyond their capitals.
    - Rights to land and peoples passed to local rulers, who subdivided them among smaller lords; inferior lords **paid tribute** and **supplied war manpower** in return for **protection**.

    - Fiefs were grants delegated by the Emperor or a superior lord, originally not hereditary; gradually local lords' families took them over → **proliferation of autonomous units**, often at war.
    - Economy: serfs — peasants legally tied to the land they cultivated, forming part of the lord's property.

- **Fails every Weberian test (Slide 11):**

    - **(i) No organisation** — government by **personal ties of mutual obligation**; officials **"owned"** their offices.
    - **(ii) No definite territory** — ill-defined; authority **weakened with distance** from the nominal capital.
    - **(iii) No monopoly of force** — lords owed allegiance to **multiple superiors** with weak, overlapping authority; several nobles could claim the same lord's tribute and conscripts.

- Early centralisation attempts: **most successful** in Western/Northern Europe, **least** in Central Europe.
- One-liner: *feudalism is the mirror-image of Weber's modern state.*

4. State-Making II: Divergence, War, Absolutism, Westphalia

Keywords: Holy Roman Empire, Renaissance, centralised kingdoms, Tilly, war, absolutism, Westphalia 1648

4.1 Central vs Western/Northern Europe (Slides 12–15)

Keywords: Holy Roman Empire 800, Catholic Church, city-states, Renaissance, kingdoms by 1400

- **Central Europe — failure:**

    - Attempts to consolidate a **"Holy Roman Empire"** (from **800 CE**) failed, partly due to the **Catholic Church undermining the Emperor's authority**.
    - **Germany and Italy** stayed fragmented **until the mid-1800s**. Maps: the Empire in 814, 843, 1250 (Slide 13).

- **Upside of fragmentation:** powerful, prosperous **cities and city-states** →

    - rediscovery of humanism and classical writings — **"the Renaissance" (c. 1400–1600)**;
    - decline of the **Church's power**;
    - renewed **economic growth**, **technological progress**, the **"age of discovery"**.

- **West/North — success:** relatively centralised kingdoms in Portugal, Spain, France, England, Scotland, Denmark, Sweden; **by 1400** already near **today's sizes and boundaries**. Maps: Europe 1100 vs 1400 (Slides 14–15).

4.2 "War Made the State" (Slide 16) (memorise)

Keywords: 1400–1600, constant war, extraction, standing armies, bureaucracy, courts

- **1400–1600** was decisive. Impulse: **constant war**, demanding ever more **money** and larger, **permanent**, better-equipped forces.
- Tilly 1975: **"War made the state, and the state made war."** (bellicist theory of state formation)
- Rulers needed organisations to govern the **whole country** effectively and **uniformly**, to **extract resources** and **mobilise manpower**.
- Resulting innovations:
    - **standing armies**;
    - **bureaucracies** to administer and **tax** populations;
    - **judicial courts** to adjudicate disputes and **facilitate trade**.
- → Feedback loop: war builds the state; the state wages more war.

4.3 Royal Absolutism (Slide 17)

Keywords: 1500–1800, Louis XIV, ruthless effort, coercion, co-optation, legitimation, shifting coalitions

- Key innovation, **1500–1800**: royal absolutism — the ruler had, at least theoretically, "absolute" power.
- Louis XIV: **"L'État, c'est moi"** ("I am the state").
- Centralisation met **multiple sources of resistance**, subdued **brutally**.
- Tilly 1985: state-makers imposed their will only "through centuries of ruthless effort", by:
    - creating **staffs dependent on and loyal to the crown**;
    - making armies and bureaucrats **reliable, effective instruments** of policy;
    - blending **coercion, co-optation and legitimation** to secure acquiescence;
    - acquiring **sound information** on country, people, resources;
    - **promoting economic activity** that frees and creates resources for the state.
- "Thus it became a **game of shifting coalitions**."

4.4 Treaty of Westphalia, 1648 (Slides 18–19)

Keywords: Thirty Years War, mutual recognition, territorial integrity, mapping

- State-making **culminated** in **Westphalia (1648)**, ending the **Thirty Years War** (most European powers).
- For the **first time** it recognised the **sovereignty** of territorial rulers: they agreed to respect one another's **autonomy and territorial integrity, even after defeat in war** → Westphalian sovereignty (external sovereignty as a norm).

- Innovations in **technology, diplomacy, statecraft** → an increasingly effective **organisation** claiming a **monopoly of legitimate force**.
- Later, **mapping technology** enabled **precise boundaries**, completing the process (Weber's territory). Map: Europe 1648 (Slide 19).

5. Tilly's Six Conditions for Successful State-Building

Keywords: extractable resources, protected position, political entrepreneurs, war, homogeneity, nobility coalition

5.1 The Conditions (Slide 20) (memorise)

Keywords: success vs failure, checklist

- Tilly 1985:

1. **Availability of extractable resources.**
2. **A relatively protected position in time and space.**
3. **A continuous supply of effective "political entrepreneurs".**
4. **Success in war.**
5. **Homogeneity (or successful homogenisation) of subject populations.**
6. **Strong coalitions of the central power with the landed nobility.**

- Mnemonic: **R-P-E-W-H-C** — Resources, Protection, Entrepreneurs, War wins, Homogeneity, Coalition.

5.2 Why It Is Not Enough (Slide 20)

Keywords: map of 1648, today's map, national integration

- "Is that all? **Hardly!**" Tilly may explain the **map of Europe in 1648**, not the current world map.
- That requires nation-building and national integration, which began in Europe around this time.

6. Nation-Building: The Revolt Against Absolutism

Keywords: divine right, popular sovereignty, nationalism, England 1640s, USA 1776, France 1789

- **Contrast (Slide 21):** state-making = how state organisations asserted authority over a territory; nation-building was (initially) driven by the **reaction to royal absolutism**.
- **From divine right to popular sovereignty:**
    - Absolute monarchs claimed divine right — authority derived directly from God.
    - From the **17th century**, popular movements rejected **"natural" hierarchies** of superior and inferior men and demanded **limits on royal authority**, on the basis of popular sovereignty — "the people" should be sovereign.

    - → A shift in *internal* sovereignty: king → people/nation.

- **Nationalism as the engine:** almost everywhere these demands drew on nationalism, which inspired civil wars and revolutions:

    - *Example:* **England (1640s)**; **United States (1776)**; **France (1789)**.

- Elsewhere, nationalists **gradually** limited government power, forcing rulers to base **legitimacy** on the **sovereignty of "the nation"**.
- Two image slides frame the debate:

    - Slide 22: Albert Einstein — *"Nationalism is an infantile disease. It is the measles of mankind."* (cartoon of a crowd following a "Nationalism" flag off a cliff) → nationalism's dark side.
    - Slide 24: *"Liberté, Égalité, Fraternité"* carved in stone → the French Revolution's link between nation and popular sovereignty.

7. What Is a Nation? Anderson's Imagined Communities

Keywords: Anderson, imagined, limited, sovereign, community, invented not discovered

7.1 Definition (Slide 23) (memorise)

Keywords: imagined political community

- Anderson 1983: "A nation is an imagined political community, and imagined as both inherently limited and sovereign." (imagined communities)

7.2 The Four Terms (Slide 23)

Keywords: communion, elastic boundaries, freedom as statehood, fraternity

- **Imagined** — members know only a tiny fraction of each other, "yet in the minds of each lives the image of their communion" → nations were **invented, not discovered**.
- **Limited — finite, albeit elastic, boundaries**, beyond which lie **other nations**.
- **Sovereign** — each nation dreams of being **"free"**, i.e. **having a state**; sovereignty belongs to **the nation, not its rulers**.
- **Community** — a **"comradeship" of equal citizens**; **fraternity** makes it possible to **kill and especially to die** for the nation.
- One-liner: *imagined (never met), limited (has edges), sovereign (wants a state), community (equal comrades).*

8. Europe: Print Capitalism and Official Nationalism

Keywords: 1919, empire breakup, unification, print capitalism, newspapers, equal citizenship, official nationalism

8.1 Europe's Nation-States by 1919 (Slides 25, 27)

Keywords: WWI, multi-national empires, Germany, Italy

- Transformation of all European units into nation-states **completed by 1919** (end of WWI) via:
  - **(i) Breakup** of multi-national empires — **Austro-Hungarian, Ottoman, Russian** — along national (mostly **ethno-linguistic**) lines;
  - **(ii) Unification** of smaller independent units — *Example:* **Germany, Italy**.
- Maps: Europe 1910 (Slide 26) vs 1919 (Slide 27). In 1910, big multi-national empires (Austria-Hungary, Russia, the Ottoman Empire, Germany) dominate; by 1919, successor nation-states appear: **Poland, Czechoslovakia, Yugoslavia, Austria, Hungary, Estonia, Latvia, Lithuania**, plus a larger **Romania**.
- → Nationalism both **split** empires and **fused** principalities.

8.2 Print Capitalism and National Languages (Slides 25, 28) (memorise)

Keywords: vernacular not Latin, viable market, newspapers, state jobs

- Why *these* nations? Anderson 1983: print capitalism — the need for the print industry to use languages people could understand (not Latin), with coverage large enough to ensure a viable market.
- **National languages** came to define national **boundaries**.
- **Daily newspapers** let people "imagine" the nation by following events in **other parts of the same country**.
- **State promotion** and **competition for state jobs** were decisive in spreading national languages.

8.3 What Nationalism Changed (Slide 28)

Keywords: internal organisation, external boundaries, rule of law, democracy, weak absolutists

- By **conflict, revolution or reform**, nationalism changed both **internal organisation** and **external boundaries**.
- It promoted popular sovereignty and equal citizenship → basis for the **rule of law and democracy**.
- Nationalists succeeded because absolutist rulers were often **weaker than they claimed** — overthrown in some cases, forced into **compromises** in others.

8.4 Official Nationalism (Slide 29)

Keywords: threatened elites, anticipatory strategy, militarism, state as nation

- Eventually the **threatened elites of every major state** adopted nationalist discourse: official nationalism.

- Official nationalism: "an anticipatory strategy" adopted by dominant groups "threatened with marginalization or exclusion" in the new "nationally-imagined community".
- Its ideologies typically:
    - **de-emphasised individual equality**;
    - **played up militarism**;
    - presented the **state as the embodiment of the nation**.
- → Popular nationalism comes from below to limit rulers; official nationalism comes from above to protect them.
- Either way, nationalism in the **1800s–1900s** reshaped borders and internal organisation **worldwide**.

9. Nationalism Beyond Europe

Keywords: New World, Creole nationalism, imitation, Industrial Revolution, Japan, Siam, China, anti-colonial nationalism

9.1 Creole Nationalism in the Americas (Slides 29–31)

Keywords: earliest nation-states, Declaration of Independence, 1820s, colonial administrative borders

- Anderson 1983: the **earliest nation-states** arose **not in Europe** but in the **"New World"**, out of colonial empires — especially **North and South America**.
- **North America:** the US revolutionary war against Britain drew on nationalist ideas in the **Declaration of Independence (1776)**.
- **South America:** nation-states by roughly the **1820s**, after throwing off **Spanish and Portuguese** rule; defined **not by language** but by **old colonial administrative borders**.
- Creole nationalism:
    - Creole: descendants of European settlers in the Americas.
    - Nationalism "pioneered by settler populations from the Old Country, who shared religion, language and customs with the metropole but increasingly felt oppressed by and alienated from it".
- **Later justification (Slide 31):** supposedly **"distinctive histories"** — especially **settler–indigenous demographic blending**, plus local traditions, geographies, climates.
- → Sharing a language with the former ruler, Creole nations could not use language as the boundary — administrative units served instead.

9.2 Nationalism by Imitation (Slide 32)

Keywords: colonisation, Industrial Revolution, guns and battleships, Japan, Siam, Manchu dynasty

- Elsewhere, nationalism **spread by imitation**. By the 20th century much of the world was **colonised by European states**.
- **Industrial Revolution (1800s)** → massive asymmetry in wealth and technology (esp. **guns and battleships**), deepening European control over Africa and Asia.
- That revolution was itself **facilitated by modern states**, which promoted growth and let trade flourish within and across borders.
    - → Modern state → industrialisation → colonial dominance.
- Remaining **independent Asian countries** built top-down **official nationalisms** copied from the West — *Example:* **Japan**, **Siam/Thailand**.
- **China:** a movement mixing "the **popular nationalism** of the worldwide anti-imperialist movement with the **official nationalism** of the late nineteenth century" ended the **Manchu dynasty in the 1910s**.

9.3 Anti-Colonial Nationalism in Colonial Asia (Slide 33)

Keywords: European education, José Rizal, Ho Chi Minh, colonial schools, camaraderie, colonial borders

- Local intellectuals adopted nationalism largely **thanks to Europeans themselves**:
    - **Study in Europe** — *Example:* the Philippines' **José Rizal** (Spain); Vietnam's **Ho Chi Minh** (France).
    - **Study locally** in schools training **colonial administrators**.
- Schools and colonial offices gathered young intellectuals from **across colonial dominions**, fostering **camaraderie** — the seed of an imagined national community.
- Local nationalisms fuelled **anti-colonial struggles**; after the Europeans left (**post-WWII**), many new nation-states emerged with boundaries **very similar to colonial boundaries**.
- **Maps (Slides 34–36):**
    - Colonial Asia (Slide 34): holdings of **Britain** (India, Burma, Malaya), **France** (Indochina), the **Netherlands** (Dutch East Indies), **Japan** (Korea, Taiwan), the **US** (Philippines), **Russia** and **Portugal** (Goa, Macau, Timor); **Siam** stayed independent.
    - Today's Afro-Eurasia (Slide 35) vs **Colonial Africa 1920–1939** (Slide 36): the colonial lines largely survive as national borders.
    - African independence dates (Slide 36): **pre-1949** — Egypt, Ethiopia, Liberia, South Africa; **1950s** — Libya, Sudan, Morocco, Tunisia, Ghana, Guinea; **1960** — the largest single wave (most of French West/Equatorial Africa, Nigeria, Congo, Somalia, Madagascar); **1961–64** — Algeria, Tanzania, Uganda, Kenya, Zambia, Malawi; **1970s** — the Portuguese colonies (Angola, Mozambique, Guinea-Bissau); **1980+** — Zimbabwe, Namibia, Eritrea, South Sudan.
- → Answer to Q2 outside Europe: many of today's borders are inherited colonial lines.

9.4 Comparative Grid: Routes to the Nation-State

Keywords: popular, Creole, official, anti-colonial, boundary source

- **European popular nationalism:** revolt against absolutism; borders follow **national languages**.
- **Creole nationalism:** settlers vs metropole; borders follow **colonial administrative units**.
- **Official nationalism:** elite anticipatory strategy; militarism, state = nation (major European states, Japan, Siam).
- **Anti-colonial nationalism:** European-educated colonial elites; borders follow **colonial boundaries**.
- **China:** hybrid of popular anti-imperialist and official nationalism.

10. One-Page Revision Spine

Keywords: last-minute recap, Weber, Schmitt, Tilly, Westphalia, Anderson

7. **Framing (Slide 2):** political development = group competition (resources, visions, recognition); outcome = a **world of nation-states** via **state-formation** + **nation-building**.
8. **Modern state (Slide 3):** Weber 1919 — **organisation** + **monopoly of legitimate force** + **given territory**.
9. **Sovereignty (Slide 4):** external = independence; internal = where power resides (king → people). Schmitt 1922: "Sovereign is he who decides on the exception."
10. **Two questions (Slide 5):** how did modern states arise and prevail? Why these states and borders?
11. **East Asia first (Slide 6):** Qin **221 BCE**; Confucian merit bureaucracy; exams since **605 CE**; by **1400** China, Korea, Japan, Vietnam centralised, borders imprecise.
12. **Europe (Slides 7–11):** Rome falls **476** → fragmentation, Dark Ages (500–800); **feudalism** — weak centre, hereditary fiefs, serfs — fails all three Weberian tests.
13. **Divergence (Slides 12–15):** Holy Roman Empire fails → Germany/Italy fragmented till mid-1800s, yet city-states → Renaissance; West/North kingdoms near modern borders by 1400.
14. **War and absolutism (Slides 16–17):** Tilly 1975 "War made the state, and the state made war" → armies, tax bureaucracies, courts; absolutism 1500–1800, "L'État, c'est moi", Tilly 1985's "centuries of ruthless effort" and "shifting coalitions".
15. **Westphalia 1648 (Slides 18–19):** ends Thirty Years War; first mutual recognition of sovereignty and territorial integrity; mapping later fixes borders.
16. **Tilly's six conditions (Slide 20):** resources, protected position, political entrepreneurs, war success, homogeneity, coalition with landed nobility — explain 1648, not today.
17. **Nation-building (Slide 21):** reaction to absolutism; divine right → popular sovereignty; nationalist revolutions in England 1640s, US 1776, France 1789.
18. **Nation (Slide 23):** Anderson 1983 — imagined, limited, sovereign, community; invented, not discovered.

19. **Europe by 1919 (Slides 25–28):** empire breakup + unification; **print capitalism** → national languages and newspapers; state jobs; popular sovereignty + equal citizenship → rule of law, democracy.
20. **Official nationalism (Slide 29):** anticipatory elite strategy; less equality, more militarism, state = nation.
21. **Beyond Europe (Slides 29–33):** Creole nationalism (US 1776, South America 1820s, colonial administrative borders); imitation via Industrial Revolution and colonialism; Japan/Siam official nationalism; China ends Manchu rule 1910s; Rizal and Ho Chi Minh → anti-colonial nationalism → post-WWII states on **colonial borders**.
22. **Big picture:** state-making built the organisation and territory; nation-building moved sovereignty to the people and drew today's borders.